

to look and feel entirely different, but you will see a lot more options in KDE. GNOME scores lesser in this area. While there are several settings that you can change in GNOME, it is still not as much as KDE offers

Resource hogs?

A GUI by itself is a resource hog. There are so many extra calculations that the CPU is doing only to enable display on screen. This apart from the programs it has to run. KDE has a lot of eye candy inbuilt, which makes it inherently resource-hungry. More applications and complexities mean lesser stability. It isn't that KDE is unstable, but it's still not as stable and rugged as GNOME. A GNOME machine is far less prone to hanging than a KDE one.

Being lighter, GNOME responds faster to mouse clicks or keystrokes than KDE does when many applications are open. Bigger isn't always better, you see!

The verdict

Sorry, no verdict. Because we think there is no absolute *best* desktop out there. It is only about the best desktop for *you*. We can only risk saying that KDE it is if you like graphics or are new to Linux and have a system loaded with RAM (at least 512MB) and GNOME if you want a more stable system that uses less resources.

When you begin using Linux, which desktop to choose is the least of your worries. You should be concentrating more on configuring Net access and setting up your applications, and only then think about your desktop environment. After all, you can change it to what you want, whenever you want!